Tourniquet



Category: **Medical, Healthcare & First Aid** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 2 labs

Covers these lab items: Tourniquet

What it is used for

A tourniquet is a specialized device used by trained responders to control life-threatening bleeding from an arm or leg. Use it only for severe bleeding and follow approved first-aid training.

How to use

1. Ensure the scene is safe and call emergency services for severe bleeding.
2. Expose the injured limb and locate the bleeding site.
3. Place the tourniquet around the limb above the bleeding site, not over a joint.
4. Tighten the device according to its instructions until severe bleeding stops.
5. Secure the tourniquet and note the time of application.
6. Keep the injured person still, monitor their condition, and await emergency responders.
7. Do not loosen or remove the tourniquet; leave this to medical professionals.

⚠ Safety

- Use a tourniquet for life-threatening limb bleeding when indicated by training.
- Never place it over a joint, wound dressing, or object embedded in the limb.
- Do not cover the tourniquet; keep it visible for responders.
- Do not delay emergency care or attempt to remove an embedded object.

Care & storage

- Use a single-use tourniquet only once and replace damaged training or clinical equipment as required.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.